

Contract & Spend Approval Matrix

Defines who may approve contracts, NDAs, and spend commitments by threshold and risk.

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Review Cycle	Annual	Sensitivity	Internal
Authoritative Source	Yes	Status	Approved

Contract Approval Levels

All contractual commitments must be approved before signature in line with the thresholds below. Approval authority is based on total contract value (TCV) over the full term, inclusive of renewals.

Total Contract Value (TCV)	Required Approver	Secondary Approval
Up to \$25,000	Department Manager	None
\$25,001 – \$100,000	Head of Department	Finance Business Partner
\$100,001 – \$500,000	Director / VP	Head of Finance
Above \$500,000	Chief Financial Officer	Legal + Executive Committee

No contract may be signed until the required approver (and secondary approver where applicable) has recorded approval in the contract register. Splitting a commitment into smaller values to avoid an approval threshold is prohibited.

NDA Approval Thresholds

Non-Disclosure Agreements (NDAs) follow a lighter-weight approval path because they carry no direct financial commitment, but they still require documented approval.

NDA Type	Required Approver	Legal Review
Standard mutual NDA (template)	Department Manager	Not required
One-way NDA (template)	Department Manager	Not required
Non-standard / amended NDA	Head of Department	Mandatory
NDA involving personal or regulated data	Head of Department	Mandatory (Legal + Privacy)

Standard-template NDAs may be approved by a Department Manager. Any deviation from the approved NDA template requires Legal review before signature.

Delegation of Authority

- Approval authority may be delegated upward but never downward below the required level.
- Delegations must be recorded in writing and are valid for a maximum of 90 days.
- Emergency approvals must be ratified by the standard approver within 5 business days.